

Topic 11: Research methods – How do you carry out psychological research?

Subject content	What students need to learn:
11.1 Designing psychological research	11.1.1 Be able to identify: a. an independent variable (IV) b. a dependent variable (DV) c. extraneous variables, including (i) situational variables (ii) participant variables
	11.1.2 Understand the influence of extraneous variables and suggest possible ways to control for them, including: a. use of standardised procedures b. counterbalancing c. randomisation d. single-blind techniques e. double-blind techniques
	11.1.3 Be able to write a null hypothesis
	11.1.4 Be able to write an alternative hypothesis
	11.1.5 Methods of sampling, including strengths and weaknesses of each sampling method: a. understand target population samples b. understand random sampling c. stratified sampling d. volunteer sampling e. opportunity sampling
	11.1.6 Understand experimental and research designs, including strengths and weaknesses: a. independent measures b. repeated measures c. matched pairs

Subject content	What students need to learn:
	11.1.7 Understand the reliability and validity of the following when analysing the planning and conducting of research procedures: a. sampling methods b. experimental designs c. quantitative methods d. qualitative methods
	11.1.8 Understand ethical issues in psychological research and how to deal with ethical issues, including: a. informed consent b. deception c. confidentiality d. right to withdraw e. protection of participants